

The Offside Rule

A player is in an offside position if any part of the head, body or feet is nearer to the opponent's goal line than both the ball and the second-last opponent when the ball is played to them by a teammate. Being in an offside position is not an offence by itself; the player must also become involved in active play, for example by interfering with an opponent or gaining an advantage. There is no offside offence from a goal kick, a throw-in or a corner kick. Many competitions use the video assistant referee to review close offside decisions.